



A WORDS HAVE WEATHER STORY EBOOK

Zahra and the Bridge Back

Repair can be offered; it cannot be forced



THE HOOK

After the words

The words had stopped. The friendship hadn't. It waited somewhere between Zahra's side of the project table and Leo's.



THE BLAMING LINE

Everything?

The bridge model had tipped. Zahra had snapped, "You ruin everything." Leo stepped back as if the words had pushed him.



POSSIBLE WORD-WEATHER

A windy gap

Willo watched a windy gap open between them. The word everything blew the broken bridge into every other moment they had shared.



A PAUSE

The hall steps

Zahra sat outside. Arthur watered the rosemary and waited until the silence had room. "A bridge can be offered," he said. "The other person chooses when to cross."



PREPARE THE REPAIR

From everything to one thing

Zahra practised: not everything. The poster base. Not you always. I was worried it would fall. Not make him forgive me. Ask if he is ready.



OFFER

A bridge, not a demand

"I blamed all of you for one problem," Zahra told Leo. "I was upset that the base tipped. Can I try that conversation again?"



TIMING BELONGS TO BOTH

Not yet

Leo looked at the bridge. "Not yet. Maybe after lunch." Zahra nodded. The offer stayed open without pulling him across it.



LATER

One piece at a time

After lunch, Leo brought tape. Zahra held the base. They repaired one cardboard beam, then another. The friendship was not proved by a perfect ending. It was being handled with more care.



TRY IT TOGETHER

The repair ladder

Step 1: name your line. Step 2: name the specific issue. Step 3: say what you will change. Step 4: ask, do not demand. Step 5: respect the answer and the time requested.



WILLO WONDERS

What did Zahra not control?

Zahra could control the honesty of her repair and her next action. She could not control Leo's readiness, feelings or answer.

Adult notes

Key message: repair is an accountable offer, not a shortcut to forgiveness. Try: (1) rewrite global labels as specific observations; (2) rehearse the five-step repair ladder; (3) discuss what respectful 'not yet' can look like. Do not pressure children to hug, forgive or resume contact. Where there is bullying, coercion or harm, use the relevant school or safeguarding response rather than treating the issue as an equal disagreement.

